

Jothi Tutor Development Standards

TUTOR COMPETENCY FRAMEWORK

A practical framework for developing, observing, and evidencing high-quality academic tutoring within the Joithi Tutor Academy

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Intended Audience	Tutors, mentors, and academy leadership

1. Purpose of This Document

This document defines the competency framework used within the Joithi Tutor Academy. It specifies what tutors are expected to develop, demonstrate, and have evidenced across the residency pathway.

The framework gives the academy a shared, precise language for coaching, observation, and sign-off decisions. It replaces JTD01 v1.0 and aligns with a revised six-domain structure (A–F) that is consistent across the tutor reflection form, the mentor observation form, and the JTD05 evidence dashboard.

This document is designed to be used operationally — by mentors during coaching, by tutors during reflection, and by the mentor panel during sign-off and certification decisions. It is not an academic reference document.

Intended Audience

- Tutors progressing through the Joithi Tutor Academy
- Mentors responsible for coaching, observation, and sign-off
- Academy leadership overseeing quality, progression, and certification

Related JTA Documents

- JF02 v2.0 — The Joithi Trifecta
- JF03 — The 4T Teaching Engine
- JTS01 — Lesson Delivery Standard
- JTD02 — Tutor Lesson Reflection Standard
- JTD03 — Tutor Residency Progress Framework
- JTD04 — Mentor Observation Standard

- JTD05 — Tutor Evidence Dashboard
- JTD06 — Tutor Certification and Sign-Off Standard

2. Framework Overview

The framework contains 22 competencies organised across six domains. Each competency is assigned to a development level: JCT1 (Core), JCT2 (Developing), or JCT3 (Advanced). This maps progression from foundational teaching behaviour through to sustained, independent teaching quality.

Domain	Code	Competency Name	Level
A — Subject Knowledge	A1	Building Conceptual Understanding	JCT2
A — Subject Knowledge	A2	Identifying the Source of Student Error	JCT2
A — Subject Knowledge	A3	Modelling Expert Problem-Solving	JCT3
A — Subject Knowledge	A4	Curriculum and School Alignment Awareness	JCT1
B — Lesson Design	B1	Planning Lessons with Clear Purpose	JCT2
B — Lesson Design	B2	Sequencing Concepts for Understanding	JCT2
B — Lesson Design	B3	Using Multiple Representations	JCT3
C — Live Teaching	C1	Explaining with Clarity and Structure	JCT1
C — Live Teaching	C2	Using Diagnostic Questioning	JCT1
C — Live Teaching	C3	Actively Checking Understanding	JCT1
C — Live Teaching	C4	Managing Guided Practice	JCT2
C — Live Teaching	C5	Delivering Targeted Feedback	JCT2
D — Assessment	D1	Using Assessment to Diagnose Understanding	JCT2
D — Assessment	D2	Tracking Student Progress Over Time	JCT3
D — Assessment	D3	Planning Interventions Based on Evidence	JCT3
D — Assessment	D4	Supporting Examination Readiness	JCT3
E — Student Development	E1	Coaching Growth Mindset and Effort	JCT2

Domain	Code	Competency Name	Level
E — Student Development	E2	Developing Student Learning Habits	JCT2
F — Professional Practice	F1	Communicating Progress to Parents	JCT2
F — Professional Practice	F2	Professional Reliability and Readiness	JCT1
F — Professional Practice	F3	Engaging Productively with Mentor Feedback	JCT1
F — Professional Practice	F4	Maintaining Ethical and Professional Standards	JCT1

3. Development Levels — JCT1, JCT2, JCT3

3.1 What the Levels Mean

JCT1 — Core: The seven foundational behaviours expected of any tutor from the earliest stages of the residency. These should be visible in any lesson at any stage. A tutor who cannot demonstrate these consistently is not ready for Lead Teaching.

JCT2 — Developing: The ten competencies that reflect stronger instructional judgement, adaptability, and wider professional contribution. These develop progressively from Co-Teaching onward and are the primary focus of assessment during Lead Teaching.

JCT3 — Advanced: The five competencies that reflect sustained, high-quality teaching across time and across a teaching cycle. These become the focus during Independent Teaching and the Certification Runway.

3.2 Competency Expectations by Residency Stage

Residency Stage	Expected Competency Focus
Observation	No competency sign-off expected. Tutor builds awareness of JCT1 behaviours by observing them in live lessons.
Co-Teaching	Early JCT1 competencies begin to appear in supported teaching sections. F3 (mentor engagement) and F2 (reliability) should be visible from this stage.
Lead Teaching	All JCT1 competencies should be demonstrated consistently. JCT2 competencies begin to appear and are the primary development focus.
Independent Teaching	JCT2 competencies strengthen and consolidate. JCT3 competencies begin to appear in the 6-week supervised cycle. Certification evidence is built here.

3.3 Important Principles

- Competencies are judged by repeated observable evidence — not by a single strong moment or self-report alone.

- A tutor may demonstrate a competency early. That does not mean sign-off should follow immediately. Sign-off requires consistent demonstration across multiple lessons.
- Residency stage and competency level are related but not identical. A tutor may be in Lead Teaching and still have weak JCT1 evidence in a specific area. Address it directly — do not assume stage completion implies competency.
- Mentors must be able to justify every sign-off decision with specific lesson evidence. Vague positive impression is not evidence.

4. Certification Thresholds

Certification requires demonstrated competency across all three levels. The thresholds below define the minimum expected evidence base before a final certification decision can be made. Meeting the threshold is necessary but not sufficient — the mentor panel reviews the full evidence pattern before confirming readiness.

Level	Competencies	Threshold to Certify
JCT1 — Core	C1, C2, C3, A4, F2, F3, F4 (7 competencies)	All 7 must be demonstrated consistently by the end of Lead Teaching
JCT2 — Developing	A1, A2, B1, B2, C4, C5, D1, E1, E2, F1 (10 competencies)	At least 8 of 10 demonstrated by the end of Independent Teaching
JCT3 — Advanced	A3, B3, D2, D3, D4 (5 competencies)	At least 3 of 5 demonstrated before final certification

Where a tutor meets the numerical threshold but the quality of the evidence is weak or inconsistent, certification may be deferred. The mentor panel makes the final decision on readiness — the threshold guides it but does not replace it.

5. Domain A — Subject Knowledge

These four competencies concern how well the tutor understands and communicates the subject content they are teaching. Subject knowledge is necessary but not sufficient. What matters is whether the tutor can make that knowledge accessible, diagnosable, and useful for the student.

A1	Building Conceptual Understanding JCT2 The tutor goes beyond delivering content. They help the student understand why something is true, how it connects to other ideas, and how to reason with it — not just recall or reproduce it. A strong explanation gives the student a reasoning framework they can apply to new situations, not just a method to copy.	Observable • Tutor explains the logic behind a step, not only the step itself • Student can articulate the concept in their own words after explanation • Explanation connects to prior knowledge or	Weak Practice • Tutor restates the textbook definition without unpacking it • Student can reproduce the worked example but cannot explain it

		a real-world context	
A2	Identifying the Source of Student Error JCT2 When a student makes a mistake, the tutor identifies not just that the answer is wrong but why the thinking went wrong. This is a diagnostic act. The tutor reads the student's work, listens to their reasoning, and locates the specific point where understanding broke down — whether that is a conceptual gap, a procedural slip, or a misapplied rule.	Observable - Tutor names the specific misunderstanding, not just the wrong answer - Correction targets the root cause, not the surface error - Tutor distinguishes between conceptual errors and procedural slips	Weak Practice - Tutor says 'that is wrong' and gives the right answer without addressing the thinking - Tutor corrects the answer but leaves the misconception in place
A3	Modelling Expert Problem-Solving JCT3 The tutor makes their problem-solving process visible. This includes how to start an unfamiliar problem, how to decide what to try next, and how to recover when the first approach fails. This goes beyond showing a worked example. It teaches the student how experts think through difficulty — which is a learnable and transferable skill.	Observable - Tutor narrates their reasoning aloud during worked examples - Tutor explicitly models what to do when stuck, not just when it works - Student can describe the approach used, not just the solution reached	Weak Practice - Tutor works through the problem silently and presents only the solution - Student learns the answer to that problem but not how to approach the next one
A4	Curriculum and School Alignment Awareness JCT1 The tutor checks with the student what the school is currently teaching, which topics are coming up, and when assessments are due. Jothi teaching should reinforce and support school learning — not run independently of it. Before deciding on lesson content, the tutor confirms what is most relevant to the student's current school context. This prevents the legitimate criticism that Jothi is teaching off-topic.	Observable - Tutor asks about school topics and upcoming tests at the start of or before the lesson - Lesson focus connects to what the student needs most right now at school - Tutor adjusts content when school priorities shift	Weak Practice - Tutor decides lesson content from Jothi's internal plan without checking school context - Student receives strong Jothi teaching on a topic that school has not yet reached

6. Domain B — Lesson Design

These three competencies concern how the tutor plans and structures learning before and within lessons. Strong lesson design is the difference between a lesson that builds understanding progressively and one that covers content without developing it.

B1	Planning Lessons with Clear Purpose JCT2 Every lesson the tutor leads should begin with a clear intention: what will be taught, what understanding is expected by the end, and where students are likely to struggle. This does not mean writing a lengthy lesson plan every time. It means the tutor arrives prepared, knows the shape of the lesson, and has thought about what to do if the material proves harder or easier than expected.	Observable - Tutor can state the lesson focus simply before the lesson begins - Explanation is sequenced and builds toward a clear outcome - Tutor has anticipated likely difficulties and has a response ready	Weak Practice - Tutor decides what to teach as the lesson unfolds - Lesson drifts between topics without a clear logic connecting them
B2	Sequencing Concepts for Understanding JCT2 Within a lesson, ideas must be introduced in a logical order. A concept that depends on a prior one must come after it, not before it. The tutor identifies the right entry point for the student and moves through the material in a sequence that builds understanding progressively. Students should be able to follow the logic of why the lesson developed in the order it did.	Observable - Each new idea builds clearly on the one before it - Student can follow the reasoning behind the lesson's sequence - Tutor does not introduce advanced ideas before securing foundations	Weak Practice - Tutor jumps between disconnected ideas without establishing what connects them - Student is confused by concepts they were not yet ready for
B3	Using Multiple Representations JCT3 When one explanation does not produce understanding, a strong tutor reframes the idea using a different representation — a diagram, an analogy, a numerical rather than algebraic approach, or a real-world context. The ability to represent the same concept in multiple ways is both a mark of deep subject knowledge and a critical teaching skill. It ensures that students who	Observable - Tutor reaches for a different approach when the first has not worked - Student can access the idea through at least two different routes	Weak Practice - Tutor repeats the same explanation more slowly or more loudly when the student does not understand - Student is stuck and the

	do not access one route can access another.	Representations are chosen deliberately, not randomly	tutor has no alternative way in
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7. Domain C — Live Teaching

These five competencies are the core of what happens inside a lesson. They are the most directly observable by mentors and the most immediately connected to student learning. JCT1 competencies C1, C2, and C3 must be consistent before Lead Teaching is considered secure.

C1	Explaining with Clarity and Structure JCT1 The tutor breaks every explanation into manageable steps. Each step is clear before the next one begins. The reasoning behind each move is made visible — not just the result. Board work supports the spoken explanation and paces it appropriately. Students can follow the explanation without having to guess what happened between steps.	Observable - Student can follow the explanation in real time without falling behind - Board shows each step clearly with no unexplained jumps - Tutor explains why each step follows from the previous one	Weak Practice - Tutor explains fluently in a way that makes sense to them but leaves the student behind - Board shows only final answers, not the reasoning that produced them
C2	Using Diagnostic Questioning JCT1 The tutor asks questions that reveal what the student is actually thinking — not just whether they got the answer right. Diagnostic questions expose reasoning, probe assumptions, and surface misconceptions. They are used throughout the lesson, not only at the end, and the tutor uses the answers to decide what to do next. 'Do you understand?' is not a diagnostic question.	Observable - Questions require the student to explain, justify, predict, or compare - Tutor uses the student's answer to inform the next teaching move - Questions probe reasoning even when the answer is correct	Weak Practice - Tutor asks 'Is that clear?' and accepts 'Yes' as evidence of understanding - Questions test recall only and do not reveal the thinking behind the answer
C3	Actively Checking Understanding JCT1 Before moving on, the tutor verifies that the student has genuinely understood —	Observable Tutor pauses after explanation to	Weak Practice Tutor moves on after a correct answer without

	not assumed it from a correct answer or a confident nod. Checking may happen through a follow-up question, a short task, or asking the student to explain the idea back in their own words. A correct answer without visible reasoning is not sufficient evidence of understanding.	check understanding deliberately • Student is asked to demonstrate understanding, not just confirm it • Tutor probes reasoning behind a correct answer before moving on	checking whether the reasoning is secure • Understanding is assumed from surface confidence rather than evidence
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C4	Managing Guided Practice JCT2 When the student works through problems, the tutor observes closely without taking over. The tutor watches for hesitation, error patterns, and signs of guessing — and intervenes only enough to help the student continue working, not to complete the work for them. The cognitive load should stay on the student. Guided practice is the phase where independence is built, not managed away.	Observable • Student does the thinking; tutor asks questions rather than giving answers • Tutor notices hesitation and error patterns without immediately correcting them • Student's work reveals their reasoning, not just their conclusions	Weak Practice • Tutor steps in too quickly and completes the problem • Student does not need to think because the tutor is thinking for them
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C5	Delivering Targeted Feedback JCT2 When the student makes an error or completes work, the tutor gives feedback that is specific, instructional, and actionable. Feedback should identify what is wrong, explain why it is wrong, and guide the student toward the correct reasoning. The student should know exactly what to do differently as a result. A mark or 'that is not right' is not feedback.	Observable • Feedback identifies the specific error and its cause • Student can act on the feedback within the same lesson • Feedback is linked to a teaching move, not just a correction	Weak Practice • Tutor marks work right or wrong without explanation • Feedback is generic: 'nearly there,' 'check your working,' 'have another look'
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8. Domain D — Assessment

These four competencies define how the tutor uses evidence of student understanding to make teaching decisions. Assessment at Jothe is embedded in teaching — it is not a separate event. D1 appears at JCT2 because using assessment diagnostically requires instructional maturity. D2, D3, and D4 appear at JCT3 because they require sustained evidence across a teaching cycle.

D1	Using Assessment to Diagnose Understanding JCT2 The tutor treats every test, task, and question as a source of information about student thinking — not just a measure of their score. Assessment evidence should tell the tutor which concepts are secure, which are fragile, and which are misunderstood. This information must directly influence what happens in the next lesson. Assessment that does not change teaching has no developmental value.	Observable - Tutor can explain what a student's result reveals about their understanding - Lesson decisions connect clearly to assessment evidence - Tutor distinguishes between secure understanding and surface performance	Weak Practice - Tutor records a mark and moves on to the next topic - Assessment tells the tutor how many questions were right but nothing about why
D2	Tracking Student Progress Over Time JCT3 The tutor maintains a picture of how the student is developing across lessons, not just in isolated sessions. This means noticing patterns: recurring errors, topics that seemed secure but have weakened, and areas where confidence and understanding are genuinely growing. Progress is not the accumulation of completed topics. It is the development of reliable, transferable understanding over time.	Observable - Tutor can describe what has changed in the student's performance over several lessons - Lesson planning reflects what the tracking evidence shows - Tutor notices when previously secure knowledge has become unstable	Weak Practice - Tutor treats each lesson independently with no connection between sessions - Progress is defined by topics covered rather than understanding demonstrated
D3	Planning Interventions Based on Evidence JCT3 When assessment or observation reveals that a student is not progressing as expected, the tutor makes a deliberate and considered decision about what to do next. This may mean reteaching a concept differently, slowing pace, revisiting a prerequisite, or raising a concern with a mentor. An intervention is a structured response to evidence — not a spontaneous	Observable - Tutor can explain why a specific change was made and what evidence triggered it - Change in approach is deliberate and	Weak Practice - Tutor continues with the original plan regardless of what assessment is showing - Problems are noticed but not acted on systematically

	reaction or the assumption that more of the same practice will eventually work.	documented where appropriate Tutor escalates concerns when progress is blocked by something beyond teaching alone	
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D4	Supporting Examination Readiness JCT3 The tutor prepares students for assessed work in a way that builds genuine exam capability — not just familiarity with past papers. This includes knowing the student's exam timeline and school assessment schedule, building disciplined written method and question interpretation, and ensuring understanding is secure enough to transfer to unseen questions. Exam preparation at Johti sits on top of real understanding. It does not replace it.	Observable - Tutor knows the student's exam timeline and aligns lesson priorities accordingly - Exam practice is connected to conceptual understanding, not substituted for it - Student can tackle variation in exam questions, not only reproduce memorised solutions	Weak Practice - Tutor drills past papers without checking whether underlying concepts are understood - Student can answer the memorised version of a question but fails on any variation

9. Domain E — Student Development

These two competencies concern the tutor's responsibility for the student's broader academic growth — their mindset, habits, and relationship with learning. Both are evidenced through mentor notes, tutor reflections, and accumulated observations rather than through a single lesson. No exemplar video is required for Domain E.

These competencies express the Mindset dimension of the Johti Trifecta. For the philosophical foundation, see JF02 v2.0.

E1	Coaching Growth Mindset and Effort JCT2 The tutor actively shapes how the student responds to challenge and error. When a student gives up, avoids difficulty, or interprets a mistake as evidence of inability, the tutor intervenes constructively. This is not vague encouragement. It is helping the student understand that effort and deliberate practice — not fixed ability — are the actual	Observable - Tutor responds to frustration or avoidance with a specific constructive move, not just reassurance - Student is encouraged to	Weak Practice - Tutor ignores fixed-mindset language or offers generic positivity that does not challenge it - Student learns to avoid difficulty

	mechanisms of improvement. The tutor should model this stance consistently.	attempt difficult work and to treat errors as information Tutor challenges fixed-mindset language when it appears	rather than persist through it
E2	Developing Student Learning Habits JCT2 The tutor helps the student build habits that extend learning beyond the Johti lesson — consistent revision, spaced practice, preparation for sessions, and self-monitoring. The direct tutor relationship makes this possible in a way that school teaching often cannot. The tutor notices when learning habits are weak and addresses them practically, not with vague advice to 'revise more.'	Observable - Tutor asks about independent practice and revision between sessions - Advice on learning habits is specific and actionable, not generic - Tutor follows up on habit targets from previous sessions	Weak Practice - Tutor focuses entirely on in-lesson teaching and ignores what the student does between sessions - Advice is limited to 'make sure you practise' without a concrete plan

10. Domain F — Professional Practice

These four competencies define the professional standards expected of all JTA tutors. F2, F3, and F4 appear at JCT1 because they are the baseline of professional operation — expected from the first day of the residency, not developed gradually. F1 appears at JCT2 because parent communication requires instructional maturity and relevant lesson evidence to do well. No exemplar video is required for Domain F.

F1	Communicating Progress to Parents JCT2 The tutor provides parents with clear, evidence-based, professionally toned updates on the student's learning. Updates should explain what the student understands well, where gaps remain, and what the next focus is. Communication must be grounded in what has actually been observed and assessed — not in general impression or uninformed optimism. All communication follows Johti's approved channels and processes.	Observable - Updates reference specific learning evidence, not vague impressions - Parents receive a meaningful picture of progress and next steps - Communication is professional in tone and clear enough for	Weak Practice - Updates are generic: 'she is doing well,' 'he is making progress' - Communication is ungrounded in evidence or bypasses approved channels
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		a non-specialist reader	
F2	Professional Reliability and Readiness JCT1 The tutor arrives on time, prepared to teach, with equipment working and materials ready. Lessons begin purposefully. Cancellations are handled through the correct process with appropriate notice. The Ayotree attendance record is completed accurately after every lesson. Professional reliability is the minimum standard of practice — it is not optional and not negotiable.	Observable - Tutor is consistently on time and technically set up before the lesson begins - Attendance is recorded accurately in Ayotree after every session - Cancellations follow the correct process with proper notice	Weak Practice - Late starts, repeated technical failures, or inaccurate attendance records - Casual cancellations without following the correct process
F3	Engaging Productively with Mentor Feedback JCT1 The tutor treats mentor observation and feedback as a development tool, not a judgement to be managed or endured. This means listening without defensiveness, acting on improvement targets in the next lesson, completing reflections honestly, and bringing questions and concerns to the mentor proactively. A tutor who engages well with feedback develops faster and builds the trust that informs sign-off decisions.	Observable - Tutor acts on the previous observation's improvement target in the next lesson - Reflections are specific, honest, and not written as an administrative requirement - Tutor raises questions and concerns proactively rather than waiting passively	Weak Practice - Tutor completes forms as a tick-box exercise without engaging developmentally - Feedback is acknowledged but not acted on in subsequent lessons
F4	Maintaining Ethical and Professional Standards JCT1 The tutor operates within Johti's safeguarding, GDPR, and online safety requirements at all times. All student information is handled carefully and shared only through authorised channels. Professional boundaries with students and parents are maintained consistently. If a concern arises — safeguarding, welfare, or conduct — the tutor escalates it promptly through the correct process and does not attempt to handle it alone.	Observable - Tutor uses approved communication channels consistently - Student information is handled appropriately and confidentially - Concerns are escalated promptly	Weak Practice - Informal communication outside approved channels - Failure to escalate a concern, or attempting to resolve it without mentor involvement



	through the correct process	
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11. How Competencies Are Evidenced

Every sign-off decision must be grounded in identifiable evidence from live teaching. The following sources are accepted as evidence within the JTA system.

Evidence Source	What It Shows
Mentor Observation Record (JTD04 form)	The primary source of competency evidence. Shows what was observable in live teaching, with specific lesson detail.
Tutor Reflection Record (JTD02 form)	Secondary source. Shows developmental awareness and engagement with feedback. Does not substitute for observed evidence.
Zoom Lesson Recording with Timestamp	Supports specific evidence claims. A timestamp linked to a specific teaching moment is stronger than a general assertion.
Cumulative Dashboard Evidence (JTD05)	Shows patterns across lessons. Used by the mentor panel to review overall competency coverage before certification.
Assessment and Progress Records	Relevant for D2, D3, and D4. Shows how the tutor is interpreting and acting on student performance data.
Parent Communication Samples	Relevant for F1. Reviewed by mentor when F1 sign-off is being considered.

Evidence Quality Standards

- Evidence must be specific. A general comment such as 'good lesson' does not support sign-off.
- Evidence must be repeated. A single strong lesson is an early indicator, not a sign-off basis.
- Evidence must be credible. The mentor making the sign-off judgement must have observed the relevant teaching directly or reviewed a recording.
- Self-report alone — including tutor reflection ratings — does not constitute sufficient evidence for sign-off at any level.

12. Common Misuse — What to Avoid

The following practices undermine the value of the framework and reduce the credibility of sign-off decisions.

Misuse	Why It Matters
Signing off a competency after one good lesson	One lesson proves a moment, not a capability. Readiness requires pattern.
Treating the 22 competencies as a checklist to complete	The framework describes teaching quality, not task completion. Ticking boxes without genuine evidence is meaningless.

Misuse	Why It Matters
Conflating residency stage with competency level	Being in Lead Teaching does not mean JCT1 is complete. Both must be assessed independently.
Using the framework as a performance management tool	This framework is a development tool. It should guide coaching, not threaten tutors.
Applying identical expectations to all tutors at the same stage	Development is not uniform. Some tutors will develop JCT2 competencies before others. The framework should accommodate this without lowering standards.

13. Version Notes — Changes from v1.0

This version (v2.1) replaces JTD01 v2.0 (April 2026) in full. The changes are structural, not merely editorial.

Change	Reason
Framework reorganised from JCT1/JCT2/JCT3 tiers to A–F domains with JCT level tags	The A–F domain structure is used in JTD05 (evidence dashboard), both Google forms, and the exemplar library. A single taxonomy across all tools prevents misalignment.
Competency count reduced from 30 to 22	Eight competencies were removed where they duplicated others or described outcomes rather than observable teaching behaviours.
Full descriptors added for all 22 competencies	v1.0 used short labels. v2.0 provides a clear description, observable indicators, and weak practice markers for each competency.
Certification thresholds made explicit	v1.0 did not specify how many competencies were required. v2.0 sets clear thresholds per level.
D4 (Exam Preparation) updated to include school curriculum alignment check	Tutors must check what the student's school is covering and when assessments are due, not only prepare students for exam technique.

Jothi Learning — United Kingdom

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